

Campaign Structure & Match Type Strategy Guide

The Auto -> Broad -> Phrase -> Exact structure, and the weekly harvest loop that makes it worth building.

Why structure matters more than any single setting

Two accounts can run the exact same bids and budgets and get very different results, because structure — how campaigns and match types are split — determines what Amazon's algorithm learns from, and how easily you can read what's working. A tangled structure makes every later optimization harder, even a correct one.

The three Sponsored Products match types

Match type	Matches	Role in the funnel
Broad	Loose variations, synonyms, related terms	Discovery — surfaces search terms you haven't thought of
Phrase	The exact phrase, with words before/after	Mid-funnel — narrower discovery once broad has been mined
Exact	The exact term only (plus close variants)	Harvest & scale — proven converters get their own controlled b

Recommended campaign structure

- **Auto campaign** — one per product (or tightly related product group). Lets Amazon's own matching surface search terms and ASINs you didn't target explicitly. Its main job is feeding your harvest process, not driving efficient scale on its own.
- **Broad match campaign** — a curated list of head terms and themes, cast wide on purpose. Expect a higher ACOS here; it's discovery spend, not scale spend.
- **Phrase match campaign** — terms that performed in Broad, narrowed down. Bridges discovery and the tightly controlled Exact tier.
- **Exact match campaign** — every proven-converting search term gets its own keyword here, each with its own bid. This is where most of a mature account's efficient spend should live.

The harvesting workflow that ties it together

- 1 Pull the Search Term Report weekly for Auto and Broad campaigns.
- 2 Any search term with enough clicks to be statistically meaningful and zero orders becomes a negative exact in that campaign (and any sibling campaign targeting the same term).
- 3 Any search term that converts gets added as its own exact-match keyword in the Exact campaign, with a bid set from your own bid calculator or historical CPC — not copied blindly from the Auto/Broad bid.
- 4 Once a term is live as an exact match with its own bid, negative it out of Auto and Broad so you're not bidding against yourself in the same auction.

- 5 Repeat weekly. A structure only pays off if the harvest loop actually runs — a perfect structure with a stale Search Term Report is no better than no structure at all.

Common mistakes

- Mixing Auto, Broad, Phrase, and Exact targeting inside one campaign — it makes bid control and reporting nearly impossible to untangle later.
- Harvesting winners into Exact but forgetting to negative them out of Auto/Broad, which just means you're now competing against your own ad in the same auction.
- Setting Exact-match bids by copying the Auto campaign's bid instead of calculating one from actual CVR and order value for that specific keyword.
- Treating structure as a one-time setup task instead of a recurring weekly habit — the harvest loop is what makes the structure worth having.

This is a general-purpose structure pattern, not a rule for every account — a very small catalog or a brand-new listing with little search volume may not need all four campaign types from day one.

Project Amazon PH Academy — Download Center. Educational reference material; verify against current Amazon Ads policy and your account's own data before acting.